

0.0.1 The Brahma Tissa

1. Thus was heard by me: At one time the Auspicious One was dwelling at Rajagaha on the Gijjhakuta mountain. Then the night having advanced, two devas of stunning beauty, having illuminated almost the whole Gijjhakuta, visited with the Auspicious One. Upon arrival, having bowed down to the Auspicious One, they stood to one side. Standing to one side, one deva said this to the Auspicious One. “These bhikkhunis, O Bhante are liberated.” Another deva said this to the Auspicious One: “These bhikkhunis, O Bhante are well-liberated without residue remaining.” This is what those devas said. The Teacher approved. Those devas [knowing], The Teacher has approved, having bowed down, having circumambulated the Auspicious One, they disappeared right

tissabrahma suttaṃ

evaṃ me suttaṃ: ekaṃ samayaṃ bhagavā rājagahe viharati gijjhakūṭe pabbate. atha kho dve devatā abhikkantāya rattiyaṃ abhikkantavaṇṇā kevalakappaṃ gijjhakūṭaṃ obhāsetvā yena bhagavā tenupasaṅkamimṣu. upasaṅkamitvā bhagavantam abhivādetvā ekamantaṃ aṭṭhaṃsu. ekamantaṃ ṭhitā kho ekā devatā bhagavantam etadavoca: etā bhante bhikkhuniyo vimuttāti. aparā devatā bhagavantam etadavoca etā bhante bhikkhuniyo anupādisesā suvimuttāti. idamavocaṃ tā devatā. samanuaṇṇo satthā ahosi. atha kho tā devatā sama-

there.

2. Then when the night had passed, the Auspicious One addressed the bhikkhus. “This night, O bhikkhus, two devas of stunning beauty, having illuminated almost the whole Gijjhakuta, visited me. Upon arrival, having bowed down to me, they stood to one side. Having stood to one side, one deva said this to me: “These bhikkhunis, O Bhante are liberated.” Another deva said this to me: “These bhikkhunis, O Bhante are well-liberated without residue remaining.” This, O bhikkhus, is what those devas said. Having said this, having bowed down, having circumambulated me, they disappeared right there.”

nuñño satthāti bhagavantam abhivādetvā padakkhiṇam katvā tatthevantara-dhāyimsu.

atha kho bhagavā tassā rattiyā acca-yena bhikkhū āman-tesi: imaṃ bhikkhave, rattim dve devatā abhikkantāya rattiyā abhikkantavaṇṇā kevalakappam gij-jhakūṭam obhāsetvā yenāham tenupasaṅkamimsu. upasaṅka-mitvā maṃ abhivādetvā ekamantaṃ aṭṭhaṃsu. ekamantaṃ ṭhitā kho bhikkhave ekā devatā maṃ etadavoca: etā bhante, bhikkhuniyo vimut-tāti. aparā devatā maṃ etadavoca: etā bhante, bhikkhuniyo anupādisesā suvi-muttāti. idamavo-cuṃ bhikkhave, tā

3. At that time, the venerable Mahamoggallana was seated not far from the Auspicious One. Then for the venerable Mahamoggallana, this occurred: “For which devas is there knowledge thus: “There is residual remaining,” when residual remains therein, or “there is no residual remaining,” when no residual remains therein?”

4. Now at that time a bhikkhu named Tissa had recently passed away and arisen in a certain brahma world. There too they knew him thus: “The brahma Tissa, of great power, of great majesty.”

devatā. idaṃ vatvā
maṃ abhivādetvā
padakkhiṇaṃ katvā
tatthevantaradhā-
yimsu’ti.

tena kho pana sama-
yena āyasmā mahā-
moggallāno bhaga-
vato avidūre nisinno
hoti. atha kho āyas-
mato mahā moggal-
lānassa etadahosi:
katamesānaṃ kho
devānaṃ evaṃ ñā-
naṃ hoti savupādi-
sese vā savupādises-
soti, anupādisese vā
anupādisesoti.

tena kho pana sa-
mayena tisso nāma
bhikkhu adhunā kā-
lakato aññataraṃ
brahmalokaṃ upa-
panno hoti. tatrapī-
naṃ evaṃ jānanti:
“tisso brahmā ma-
hiddhiko mahānu-
bhāvo”ti.

5. So then, just as a strong man might bend back his outstretched arm or stretch out his bent arm, just so the venerable Mahamoggallana disappeared from the Gi-jjhakuta mountain and appeared in the brahma world. The brahma Tissa saw the venerable Mahamoggallana approaching from afar. Having seen, he said this to the venerable Mahamoggallana:

6. Come dear sir Moggallana, welcome dear sir Moggallana. It has been long, dear sir Moggallana, since this arrangement was made, specifically for your coming here. Have a seat dear sir Moggallana. This seat is ready. The venerable Mahamoggallana sat down on

atha kho āyasmā mahāmoggallāno seyya-thāpi nāma balavā puriso sammiñjitaṃ vā bāhaṃ pasāreyya pasāritaṃ vā bāhaṃ sampiñjeyya, evamevaṃ gi-jjhakūṭe pabbate antarahito tasmim̐ brahmaloke pāturahosi. addasā kho tisso brahmā āyasmantaṃ mahāmoggallānaṃ dūratova āgacchantam̐ disvāna āyasmantaṃ mahāmoggallānaṃ etadavoca:

ehi kho mārīsa moggallāna, svāgataṃ mārīsa moggallāna, cirassaṃ kho mārīsa moggallāna, imaṃ pariyāyamakāsi ya-didaṃ idhāgama-nāya. nisīda mārīsa moggallāna, idamāsanam̐ paññattanti. nisīdi kho āyasmā

the prepared seat. The brahma Tissa, having bowed down to the venerable Mahamoggallana, also sat down to one side. Having sat down to one side, the venerable Mahamoggallana said this to the brahma Tissa:

7. “For which devas is there knowledge thus: “There is residual remaining,” when residual remains therein, or “there is no residual remaining,” when no residual remains therein?”

8. “For the devas of the brahma group, dear sir Moggallana, there is knowledge thus: “There is residual remaining,” when residual remains therein, or “there is no residual remaining,” when no residual remains therein?”

mahāmoggaḷlāno paññatte āsane. tis-sopi kho brahmā āyasmantaṃ mahā-moggallānaṃ abhi-vādetvā ekamantaṃ nisīdi. ekamantaṃ nisinnaṃ kho tissaṃ brahmānaṃ āyasmā mahā moggaḷlāno etadavoca:

katamesānaṃ kho tissa, devānaṃ evaṃ ñāṇaṃ hoti saupādisese vā saupādisesoti, anupādisese vā anupādisesoti?

brahmakāyikānaṃ kho mārisa moggallāna, devānaṃ evaṃ ñāṇaṃ hoti: saupādisese vā saupādisesoti, anupādisese vā anupādisesoti.

9. “Is there knowledge, O Tissa, for all the devas of the brahma group, thus: “There is residual remaining,” when residual remains therein, or “there is no residual remaining,” when no residual remains therein?”

10. Not for all the devas of the brahma group, dear sir Moggallana, is there knowledge thus: “There is residual remaining,” when residual remains therein, or “there is no residual remaining,” when no residual remains therein?” Those devas of the brahma group, dear sir Moggallana, who are contented with the brahma life span, contented with the brahma beauty, with the brahma happiness, with the brahma fame, with the brahma rulership, those who do not know of a higher escape than that, as it has come to be, for them there is no knowledge thus: “There is

sabbesaṃyeveva nu kho¹ tissa, brahma-kāyikānaṃ devānaṃ evaṃ ñāṇaṃ hoti: saupādisese vā saupādisesoti, anupādisese vā anupādisesoti.

na kho mārisa moggallāna, sabbesaṃ brahmakāyikānaṃ devānaṃ evaṃ ñāṇaṃ hoti: saupādisese vā saupādisesoti, anupādisese vā anupādisesoti. ye kho te mārisa moggallāna, brahma-kāyikā devā brahmena āyunaṃ santuṭṭhā, brahmena vaṇṇena brahmena sukhena brahmena yasena brahmena ādhipateyyena santuṭṭhā, tassa ca uttarim² nissaraṇaṃ yathābhūtaṃ nappajānantī, tesāṃ na

residual remaining,” when residual remains therein, or “there is no residual remaining,” when no residual remains therein.” But those devas of the brahma group, dear sir Moggallana, who are not contented with the brahma life span, not contented with the brahma beauty, with the brahma happiness, with the brahma fame, with the brahma rulership, those who know of a higher escape than that, as it has come to be, for them there is knowledge thus: “There is residual remaining,” when residual remains therein, or “there is no residual remaining,” when no residual remains therein?”

11. Here dear sir Moggallana, a bhikkhu is both ends liberated. By that the devas understand thus: “This venerable one is both ends liberated. For as long as his body

evaṃ ñāṇaṃ hoti: saupādisese vā saupādisesoti, anupādisese vā anupādisesoti. ye ca kho te mārīsa moggallāna, brahmacārikā devā brahmena āyunaṃ asantuṭṭhā, brahmena vaṇṇena brahmena sukhena brahmena yasena brahmena ādhipateyyena asantuṭṭhā, tassa ca uttariṃ² nissaraṇaṃ yathābhūtaṃ pajānanti, tesāṃ evaṃ ñāṇaṃ hoti: saupādisese vā saupādisesoti, anupādisese vā anupādisesoti.

idha mārīsa moggallāna bhikkhu ubhatobhāgavimutto hoti tamenāṃ devā¹ evaṃ jānanti: ayaṃ kho āyasmā ubhatobhāgavimutto, yāvassa

remains, for that long devas and humans will see him. With the breakup of the body, after death, devas and humans will not see him.” Thus too dear sir Moggallana, for those devas there is knowledge thus: “There is residual remaining,” when residual remains therein, or “there is no residual remaining,” when no residual remains therein?”

12. Still here dear sir Moggallana, a bhikkhu is wisdom liberated. By that the devas understand thus: “This venerable one is wisdom liberated. For as long as his body remains, for that long devas and humans will see him. With the breakup of the body, after death, devas and humans will not see him.” Thus too dear sir Moggallana, for those devas there is knowledge thus: “There is residual remaining,” when residual remains therein, or “there is

kāyo ṭhassati tāva naṃ dakkhinti devamanussā, kāyassa bhedaṃ na naṃ dakkhinti devamanussāti evampi kho mārisa moggallāna, tesam devānaṃ evaṃ ñāṇaṃ hoti: saupādisese vā saupādisesoti, anupādisese vā anupādisesoti.

idha pana mārisa moggallāna, bhikkhu paññāvimutto hoti tamenam te devā evaṃ jānanti: ayaṃ kho āyasmā paññāvimutto, yāvassa kāyo ṭhassati tāva naṃ dakkhinti devamanussā, kāyassa bhedaṃ, na naṃ dakkhinti devamanussāti. evampi kho mārisa moggallāna, tesam devānaṃ ñāṇaṃ hoti: saupādisese vā saupādisese-

no residual remaining,” when no residual remains therein?”

13. Still here, dear sir Moggallana, a bhikkhu is a body witness. By that the devas understand thus: “This venerable one is a body witness. Indeed it is well if this venerable is making use of suitable lodgings, resorting to noble friends, leveling the differences in the faculties, [then] he may dwell having entered upon that unsurpassed consummation of the life of purity for the sake of which sons of clansmen justly and rightly go forth from the household life into homelessness, having realized it with his own supreme knowledge in just this very life.” Thus too dear sir Moggallana, for those devas there is knowledge thus: “There is residual remaining,” when residual remains therein, or “there is no residual remaining,” when

soti, anupādisese vā anupādisesoti.

idha pana mārīsa moggallāna bhikkhu kāyasakkhī hoti. tamenam te devā evam jānanti: ayam kho āyasmā kāyasakkhī, appeva nāma ayamāyasmā anulomikāni senāsanāni paṭisevamāno kalyāṇamitte bhajamāno indriyāni samannānāyamaṇo, yassatthāya kulaputtā samadeva agārasmā anagāriyaṃ pabbajanti, tadanuttaraṃ brahmacariyapariyosānaṃ diṭṭheva dhamme sayam abhiññā sacchikatvā upasampajja vihareyyāti. evampi kho mārīsa moggallāna, tesam devānaṃ ñāṇaṃ hoti. saupādisesevā saupādisesoti, anupādi-

no residual remains therein?”

14. Still here, dear sir Moggallana, a bhikkhu is one attained to view. By that the devas understand thus: “This venerable one is attained to view. Indeed it is well if this venerable is making use of suitable lodgings, resorting to noble friends, leveling the differences in the faculties, [then] he may dwell having entered upon that unsurpassed consummation of the life of purity for the sake of which sons of clansmen justly and rightly go forth from the household life into homelessness, having realized it with his own supreme knowledge in just this very life.” Thus too dear sir Moggallana, for those devas there is knowledge thus: “There is residual remaining,” when residual remains therein, or “there is no residual remaining,” when

sese vā anupādisesoti.

idha pana mārīsa moggallāna bhikkhu diṭṭhappatto¹ hoti. tamenam te devā evaṃ jānanti: ayaṃ kho āyasmā diṭṭhappatto¹ appēvanāma ayaṃ āyasmā anulomikāni senāsanāni paṭiseva-māno kalyāṇamitte bhajamāno indriyāni samannāyayamāno, yassatthāya kula-puttā sammadeva agārasmā anagāriyaṃ pabbajanti, tadanuttaraṃ brahmacariyapariyosānaṃ diṭṭheva dhamme sayam abhiññā sacchikatvā upasampajja vihareyyāti. evampi kho mārīsa moggallāna, tesam devānam evaṃ ñāṇaṃ hoti saupādisesevā

no residual remains therein?”

15. Still here, dear sir Moggallana, a bhikkhu is liberated by faith. By that the devas understand thus: “This venerable one is liberated by faith. Indeed it is well if this venerable is making use of suitable lodgings, resorting to noble friends, leveling the differences in the faculties, [then] he may dwell having entered upon that unsurpassed consummation of the life of purity for the sake of which sons of clansmen justly and rightly go forth from the household life into homelessness, having realized it with his own supreme knowledge in just this very life.” Thus too dear sir Moggallana, for those devas there is knowledge thus: “There is residual remaining,” when residual remains therein, or “there is

saupādisesoti, anupādisese vā anupādisesoti.

idha pana mārisa moggallāna bhikkhu saddhāvimutto hoti. tamenam te devā evaṃ jānanti: ayaṃ kho āyasmā saddhāvimutto appevanāma ayamāyasmā anulomikāni senāsanāni paṭisevamāno kalyāṇamitte bhajamāno indriyāni samannāyayamāno, yassatthāya kula-puttā sammadeva agāasmā anagāriyaṃ pabbajanti, tadanuttaram brahmacariyapariyosānaṃ diṭṭheva dhamme sayam abhiññā sacchikatvā upasampajja vihareyyāti. evampi kho mārisa moggallāna, tesam devānam evaṃ ñāṇaṃ

no residual remaining,” when no residual remains therein?”

16. Still here, dear sir Moggallana, a bhikkhu is a Dhamma follower. By that the devas understand thus: “This venerable one is a Dhamma follower. Indeed it is well if this venerable is making use of suitable lodgings, resorting to noble friends, leveling the differences in the faculties, [then] he may dwell having entered upon that unsurpassed consummation of the life of purity for the sake of which sons of clansmen justly and rightly go forth from the household life into homelessness, having realized it with his own supreme knowledge in just this very life.” Thus too dear sir Moggallana, for those devas there is knowledge thus: “There is residual remaining,” when residual

hoti saupādisesevā saupādisesoti, anupādisese vā anupādisesoti.

idha pana mārīsa moggallāna bhikkhu dhammānusārī hoti. tamenam te devā evaṃ jānanti: ayaṃ kho āyasmā dhammānusārī appewanāma ayamāyasmā anulomikāni senāsanāni paṭisevamāno kalyāṇamitte bhajamāno indriyāni samannāyāmāno, yassatthāya kula-puttā sammadeva agāasmā anagāriyaṃ pabbajanti, tadanuttaraṃ brahmacariyapariyosānaṃ diṭṭheva dhamme sayamaṃ abhiññā sacchikatvā upasampajja vihareyyāti. evampi kho mārīsa moggallāna, tesam devā-

remains therein, or “there is no residual remaining,” when no residual remains therein?”

17. Still here, dear sir Moggallana, a bhikkhu is a faith follower. By that the devas understand thus: “This venerable one is a faith follower. Indeed it is well if this venerable is making use of suitable lodgings, resorting to noble friends, leveling the differences in the faculties, [then] he may dwell having entered upon that unsurpassed consummation of the life of purity for the sake of which sons of clansmen justly and rightly go forth from the household life into homelessness, having realized it with his own supreme knowledge in just this very life.” Thus too dear sir Moggallana, for those devas there is knowledge thus: “There is residual

naṃ evaṃ ñāṇaṃ
hoti saupādisesevā
saupādisesoti, anu-
pādisese vā anupādi-
sesoti.

idha pana mārisa
moggallāna bhik-
khu saddhānusārī
hoti. tamenāṃ te
devā evaṃ jānanti:
ayaṃ kho āyasmā
saddhānusārī ap-
pevanāma ayamā-
yasmā anulomikāni
senāsanāni paṭiseva-
māno kalyāṇamitte
bhajamāno indriyāni
samannānayaṃ māno,
yassatthāya kula-
puttā sammadeva
agāasmā anagāri-
yaṃ pabbajanti, ta-
danuttaraṃ brahma-
cariyapariyosānaṃ
diṭṭheva dhamme sa-
yaṃ abhiññā sacchi-
katvā upasampajja
vihareyyāti. evampi
kho mārisa mogga-

remaining,” when residual remains therein, or “there is no residual remaining,” when no residual remains therein?”

18. Then the venerable Mahamoggallana having delighted in, having rejoiced in the brahma Tissa’s words, just as a strong man might bend back his outstretched arm or stretch out his bent arm, just so the venerable Mahamoggallana disappeared from the brahma world and appeared in the Gijjhakuta mountain.

19. Then the venerable Mahamoggallana visited with the Auspicious One. Upon arrival, having bowed down to the Auspicious One, they sat down to one side. Having sat down to one side, the venerable Mahamoggallana

lāna, tesam devā-
nam evaṃ ñāṇaṃ
hoti saupādisesevā
saupādisesoti, anu-
pādisese vā anupādi-
sesoti.

atha kho āyasmā ma-
hāmoggallāno tis-
sassa brahmuno bhā-
sitam abhinanditvā
anumoditvā seyyā-
thāpi nāma balavā
puriso sammiñjitaṃ
vā bāhaṃ pasāreyya,
pasāritaṃ vā bāhaṃ
sammiñjeyya, eva-
meva brahmaloke
antarahito gijjhakūṭe
pāturahosi.

atha kho āyasmā ma-
hāmoggallāno yena
bhagavā tenupasaṅ-
kami. upasaṅkami-
tvā bhagavantam
abhivādetvā eka-
mantam nisīdi. eka-
mantam nisinno kho
āyasmā mahāmog-

informed the Auspicious One the full extent of his friendly conversation with the brahma Tissa.

20. “But for you Moggallana, did not the brahma Tissa explain to you about the seventh individual, the one who dwells in the signless?”

21. “This is the appropriate time, O Auspicious One, this is the appropriate time, O Well-farer, the Auspicious One should teach about the seventh individual, the one who dwells in the signless? Having heard from the Auspicious One, the bhikkhus will bear it in mind.”

22. “Well then, Moggallana, listen and do mind it well. I will speak.”

gallāno yāvatako
ahosi tissena brah-
munā saddhiṃ ka-
thāsallāpo taṃ sab-
baṃ bhagavato āro-
cesi.

nahi pana te moggal-
lāna tisso brahmā
sattamaṃ animitta-
vihāriṃ puggalaṃ
desesīti.

etassa bhagavā kālo,
etassa sugata kālo,
yaṃ bhagavā satta-
maṃ animittavihā-
riṃ puggalaṃ de-
seyya, bhagavato
sutvā bhikkhū dhā-
ressantīti.

tena hi moggallāna
suṇāhi, sādhukaṃ
manasikarohi, bhā-
sissāmīti.

23. “Yes, Bhante,” the venerable Ananda assented to the Auspicious One. The Auspicious One said this:

24. Here, O Moggallana, by non-attention to all signs, a bhikkhu enters upon and dwells in the signless samadhi state of mind. By that the devas understand thus: “By non-attention to all signs, this venerable one enters upon and dwells in the signless samadhi state of mind. Indeed it is well if this venerable is making use of suitable lodgings, resorting to noble friends, leveling the differences in the faculties, [then] he may dwell having entered upon that unsurpassed consummation of the life of purity for the sake of which sons of clansmen justly and rightly go forth from the household life into homelessness, having realized it

evambhanteti kho āyasmā mahāmoggallāno bhagavato paccassosi. bhagavā etadavoca:

idha moggallāna, bhikkhu sabbanimit-tānaṃ amanasikārā animittaṃ cetosamā-dhiṃ upasampajja viharati. tamenāṃ te devā evaṃ jānanti: ayaṃ kho āyasmā sabbanimittānaṃ amanasikārā animittaṃ cetosamā-dhiṃ upasampajja viharati. appeva-nāma ayamāyasmā anulomikāni senāsa-nāni paṭisevamāno kalyāṇamitte bha-jamāno indriyāni samannāyayamāno yassatthāya kula-puttā sammadeva agāasmā anagāri-yaṃ pabbajanti, ta-danuttaraṃ brahma-

with his own supreme knowledge in just this very life.” Thus too, O Moggallana, for those devas there is knowledge thus: “There is residual remaining,” when residual remains therein, or “there is no residual remaining,” when no residual remains therein?”

cariyapariyosānaṃ
diṭṭheva dhamme sa-
yaṃ abhiññā sacchi-
katvā upasampajja
vihareyyāti. evaṃ
kho moggallāna, te-
saṃ devānaṃ ñā-
ṇaṃ hoti: saupādis-
ese vā saupādis-
esoti, anupādisese vā
anupādisesoti.

